A-A-890C
February 23, 1983
SUPERSEDING
A-A-890B
July 23, 1981

# COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

## TYPEWRITER
## (ELECTRIC, TYPEBAR)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description.

This description covers heavy duty, office (non-portable) electric, typebar typewriters drawn from currently produced lots. Heavy duty refers to service classification capability of 10 years at 4 hours per day of business week typing application prior to overhaul, i.e, 30 million impressions prior to overhaul.

Salient characteristics:

Vertical line space selection with a minimum of three positions (position 1, 6 line spaces per inch; position 2, 3 line spaces per inch; and position 3, manufacturer's option).
Variable vertical line spacer.
Carriage release (right and left).
Platen release paper removal).
Paper bail with minimum of two bail rolls.
Adjustable paper guide.
Line finder device which permits ratchet-free movement of platen and return to original line of type.
Margin warning device.
Minimum of two ribbon positions (ribbon and stencil), except for machines equipped to use cartridges.
Tabulator set.
Tabulator clear (single and total).
Shift key (right and left).
Shift lock.
Shift lock release (right and left).
Margin release.
Carrier/carriage return with automatic line feed.
Backspace.
Space bar (forward spacing).
Automatic ribbon reverse, except on machines equipped to use cartridges.
Margin set (right and left).
Repeat keys (forward spacer, back space, underscore, and hyphen).
Dust cover.
Pitch, designated in characters per inch (as specified).
Type style (as specified).
Maximum paper width and related maximum horizontal writing line capability (as specified).
Ribbon system (as specified).
Color choice (as specified from colors available in contracted manufacturer's commercial selection).
Conforms to UL Standard No. 114.

The issue of UL Standard No. 114 in effect on the date of the solicitation shall be used to determine compliance with this requirement.

Workmanship. Typewriters shall be clean, free from faulty construction or any defects which affect appearance, serviceability, or constitute a hazard to the user.

Electro-mechanical requirements.

Typewriters shall be equipped with resilient feet or base to minimize movement and prevent marring of furniture. Minimum carriage clearance, without riser, shall be 3-1/4 inches from the desktop.
All keys and operating controls shall be easily accessible and in no case shall any controls be located on the back of the typewriter.
Unless otherwise specified, typewriter keyboards shall be in accordance with the attached keyboard arrangement.
Typewriters shall operate on a 60 Hz, 115 V a.c. power source, unless otherwise specified. When specified, the typewriters shall conform to electro-magnetic interference requirements of MIL-STD-461, -462, and -463 (on/off switch excepted from the requirements of these three standards).

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Optional features, as specified.

Feature 1) Error correcting capability.
Feature 2) Proportional spacing.
Feature 3) Last line indicator.

Identification.

Each typewriter shall have the manufacturer's serial number permanently and legibly stamped or affixed on a major component in a readily accessible location.. In addition, each typewriter shall be permanently and legibly marked in a conspicuous location with the manufacturer's name or trademark.

Regulatory requirements. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. The preservation, packaging, labeling, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

UL Standard No. 114 is available from Underwriters Laboratories, Inc., 333 Pfingsten Road, Northbrook, IL 60062.

Military Standards 461, 462 and 463 are available from Naval Publications and Forms Center, 5801 Tabor Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19120.

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

GSA - FSS

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# TYPEWRITER KEYBOARD ARRANGEMENT

## 1. Scope

This description defines the arrangement of the 44 basic printing keys on the typewriter and the characters, uppercase and lowercase, that appear on the keys. It also includes the two shift keys and the space bar. However, the description does not specify the physical characteristics and dimensions of the keys and keyboard. It relates to the keyboard arrangement only.

## 2. Definitions

In this description, the following definitions shall apply:

alphabetic. Pertains to the letters in an alphabet.

alphanumeric. Pertains to the alphabet and the numerals that comprise a complete set for a particular language.

case. A group of characters similarly positioned with respect to the shift.

functional key. The key on the machine, which, when activated, produces a machine action other than a printing impression, such as space, shift, backspace, etc.

key (key top, key button). A finger-contact member, the activation of which results in a machine response.

keyboard. The area of a machine on which the printing and functional keys are arrayed.

keyboard arrangement. The position of the keys relative to one another and the arrangement of characters on them.

lowercase. A group of characters, usually containing the small alphabet, numerals, and certain symbols, that are in printing position with the shift key in its customary position (not depressed).

numeric. Pertains to arabic numbers.

printing key. A key on the machine, the activation of which results in a printing impression.

shift. The facility to change from one case to another.

symbol. Any of the punctuation marks and signs used instead of a word or words to represent an operation, relationship, spoken sound, etc.

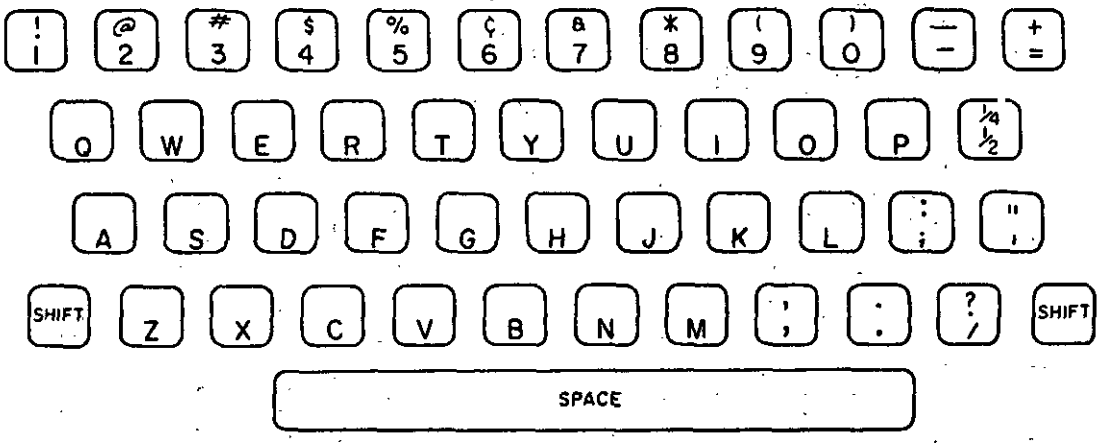
uppercase. A group of characters, usually containing the capital alphabet and certain symbols, that are brought into printing position by depressing the shift key.

## 3. Standard Keyboard Arrangement

3.1 Fig. 1 shows the standard arrangement of the keys and the characters assigned to them (including the two shifts keys and the space bar).

3.2 In Fig. 1, the keys labeled with the letters of the alphabet are intended to produce lowercase letters in unshifted (lowercase) mode and uppercase letters in the shifted (uppercase) mode. The other keys are intended to produce the lower character as shown in the key in the unshifted mode, and the upper character as shown in the key in the shifted mode.

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NOTE: Physical characteristics and locations (that is, size, shape, skew, etc) of the space bar or of the keys are not to be inferred.

*Fig. 1*
**Typewriter Keyboard Arrangement**

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